EXECUTIVE & STRATEGIC 2×2 DECISION MATRIX EDITION (AGES 12+)



PRINCE IVAN & THE GREY WOLF

An Epic 3-Chapter Tale on Wise Mentorship, Discipline, and Loyal Alliance

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Jupiter Group LLC

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Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *PRINCE IVAN & THE GREY WOLF* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: Bridges the classic Quest for the Firebird with Brothers Grimm's 'The Golden Bird' (KHM 57) and heroic mentorship epics across East and West.

Proverb of the Book: *"He who honours his mentor's word and keeps a loyal friend crosses three kingdoms undefeated."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. CHAPTER I — THE NIGHT WATCH AND THE FEATHER OF THE FIREBIRD ❧



In a Tsar's orchard stood a wondrous apple tree bearing golden fruit. Every night the glowing Firebird flew in to peck the apples. While his two older brothers slept through their watch, young Prince Ivan stayed awake till dawn and caught a single blazing tail feather—before setting out across the world to find the bird.

Where others yielded to drowsiness, Ivan's vigilance earned him the first spark of a great quest.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who honours his mentor's word and keeps a loyal friend crosses three kingdoms undefeated."*

❧ SHEET II. THE PACT WITH THE GREY WOLF IN THE DEEP FOREST ❧



Far in the wilderness Ivan met the mighty Grey Wolf—the master of the forest paths. Instead of despairing over his lost horse, Ivan spoke with respect, and the Grey Wolf became his sworn mentor and companion.

Carrying Ivan swifter than the wind to the high walled garden, the Wolf gave him one strict rule: 'Take the Firebird itself, Ivan, but do not touch the golden cage—or the alarm strings will ring!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who honours his mentor's word and keeps a loyal friend crosses three kingdoms undefeated."*

❧ SHEET III. CHAPTER II — THE TEMPTATION OF THE GOLDEN CAGE & THE GOLDEN BRIDLE ❧



Stepping into the garden, Ivan took the Firebird—yet his eyes gleamed at the jewelled golden cage. Forgetting the Wolf's warning, he reached for the cage, and a hundred bells rang out! Later, at the stables of the Golden-Maned Horse, he made the same mistake by reaching for the diamond bridle.

Twice his loyal mentor, the Grey Wolf, had to rescue him from captivity through brilliant strategy and patience.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who honours his mentor's word and keeps a loyal friend crosses three kingdoms undefeated."*

❧ SHEET IV. CHAPTER III — PRINCESS ELENA AND THE ENVY OF THE BROTHERS ❧



With the Grey Wolf's help, Ivan won the heart of Elena the Fair and returned home with the Golden-Maned Horse and the Firebird. Along the border road, however, his envious older brothers ambushed him while he rested and claimed his hard-won treasures as their own.

Even inside one's own family or company, unguarded envy can strike at the final mile.

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who honours his mentor's word and keeps a loyal friend crosses three kingdoms undefeated."*

❧ SHEET V. THE LIVING WATER OF LOYALTY AND TRIUMPH ❧



True to his word beyond every trial, the Grey Wolf revived Prince Ivan with the Water of Life, exposed the brothers' deceit before the Tsar, and blessed the joyful wedding of Ivan and Elena.

Thus the three-chapter epic crowns two laws of greatness: listen strictly to your seasoned mentor's red-lines, and guard your loyal alliance to the very end!

> ***Key Insight:*** *"He who honours his mentor's word and keeps a loyal friend crosses three kingdoms undefeated."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why did Prince Ivan succeed on the night watch when his brothers fell asleep?**
  How does staying patient and attentive when a task is quiet open the door to big adventures?
- **2. Why did touching the golden cage and the golden bridle cause so much trouble?**
  When a wise coach or parent says 'Take the main thing, don't grab the shiny wrapper,' why is self-control so important?
- **3. What made the Grey Wolf the truest friend in the world?**
  How do we show gratitude and loyalty to those who help and teach us?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *Your coach or parent gives you a clear safety rule for a trip or project, and halfway through you see something shiny that tempts you to break the rule 'just for a second.'*

Path 1 (Grabbing the Golden Cage): Break the rule for a shiny distraction and set off the alarm for the whole team.

Path 2 (Forgetting to Thank Your Helper): Take all the credit for a win and forget the friend who helped you.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (Discipline & Loyal Friendship!): Follow the wise instruction to the letter, focus on the true goal, and share the joy of victory with your mentor!

❖ **Creative Task: Draw Prince Ivan riding the swift Grey Wolf under the stars while the glowing Firebird lights their way!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Ask your child: 'Who was your wise Grey Wolf helper today, and how did you thank them for their advice?'

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: RESPECT FOR MENTORS & LOYAL FRIENDSHIP → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: SELF-DISCIPLINE & KEEPING ONE'S WORD

Lesson II • Good Heart, Impulsive Hands
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Loves the mentor, yet keeps grabbing 'golden cages' on impulse and creating emergencies.

★ ALLIANCE OF DISCIPLINE & LOYALTY
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
Listening to wise guidance, keeping self-control, and cherishing faithful companions.

Lesson I • Envy & Sleeping on Watch
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Laziness during the work followed by envy toward those who laboured honestly.

Lesson III • Cold Obedience Without Heart
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Following rules mechanically without gratitude, warmth, or true friendship.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Keep the watch and honour the rule: Self-control at the decisive moment saves three rounds of trouble.

2. Never forget the friend who carried you through the storm: Gratitude and loyalty are the crown of a noble character.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. Prince Ivan — Visionary Founder Entering Uncharted Markets:** Has the courage to stay awake on the night watch, yet lacks local operational mastery in foreign territories.
- **2. The Grey Wolf — Seasoned Strategic Advisor / COO / Local Partner:** Knows every hidden alarm string in the market and provides the execution velocity Ivan lacks.
- **3. The Golden Cage & Bridle — Scope Creep & Vanity Traps in M&A:** Reaching for non-essential status perks during a delicate acquisition or launch—triggering regulatory or competitor alarms.
- **4. The Envious Brothers — Internal Politics & IP Misappropriation:** Insiders who contribute zero effort during the R&D phase but attempt to seize credit or equity at the finish line.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

Trap 1 — Violating Your Expert Advisor's Technical Red-Lines: Hiring a world-class architect or legal counsel ('Grey Wolf') and then overriding their core warning ('grabbing the cage') out of impatience.

Trap 2 — Leaving the Final Mile of IP & Governance Unprotected: Surviving external market battles only to suffer a cap-table or attribution ambush inside the group.

★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Disciplined Execution + Protected Advisor Alliance: Follow technical red-lines strictly, take the core asset ('Firebird') without vanity noise, and lock in clear attribution and equity protection.

AXIS Y ↑: STRATEGIC ALLIANCE WITH EXPERT MENTORS → | AXIS X ►: OPERATIONAL & COMPLIANCE DISCIPLINE (IMPULSIVE SCOPE CREEP ('GOLDEN CAGE') → STRICT RED-LINE EXECUTION)

Quadrant 2 • Heroic Firefighting
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Strong advisor relationship, yet the founder's impulsive detours force repeated crisis rescues.

★ TRIUMPHANT STRATEGIC ALLIANCE
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
World-class mentorship paired with iron operational discipline and protected governance.

Quadrant 1 • Asleep on Watch & Defeated
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
No vision, no expert allies, and no discipline—resorting to internal politics.

Quadrant 3 • Solo Technician Without Scale
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Follows rules cautiously alone, but never crosses borders or captures the Firebird.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Take the Firebird, leave the Golden Cage!"	Focus 100% on the core value-creating asset and drop the risky, high-ego side demand.	**★ Strip vanity clauses that could trigger regulatory or deal-breaking alarms.**
"Listen to the Grey Wolf on this terrain"	Our domain architect or local counsel has flagged a hard red-line.	**★ Defer to verified specialist expertise without founder override.**
"Guard the final mile from the Brothers"	Protect IP attribution, legal title, and cap-table security before announcing victory.	**★ Register IP and sign definitive agreements before public rollout.**
"Who stayed awake under the golden apple tree?"	Reward those who did the quiet R&D night watch, not those who arrived for the photo.	**★ Tie equity and bonuses to verified milestone logs.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
M&A Advisory Engagement Mandate; Strict Regulatory Red-Line Compliance; IP Attribution & Founder Vesting Protection.

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